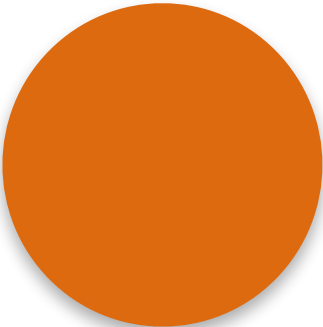


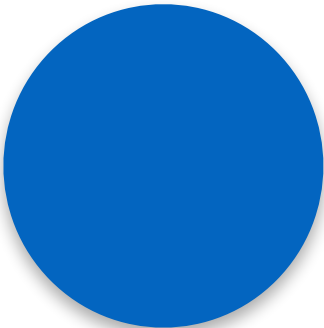


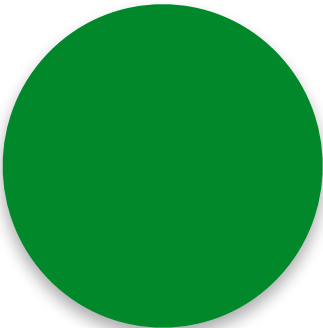


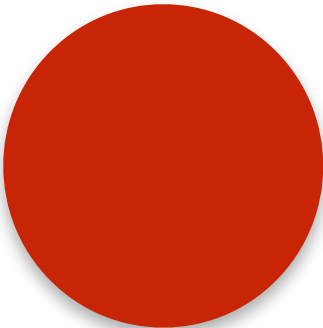














Let's turn to our last option: rejecting Proportionality.

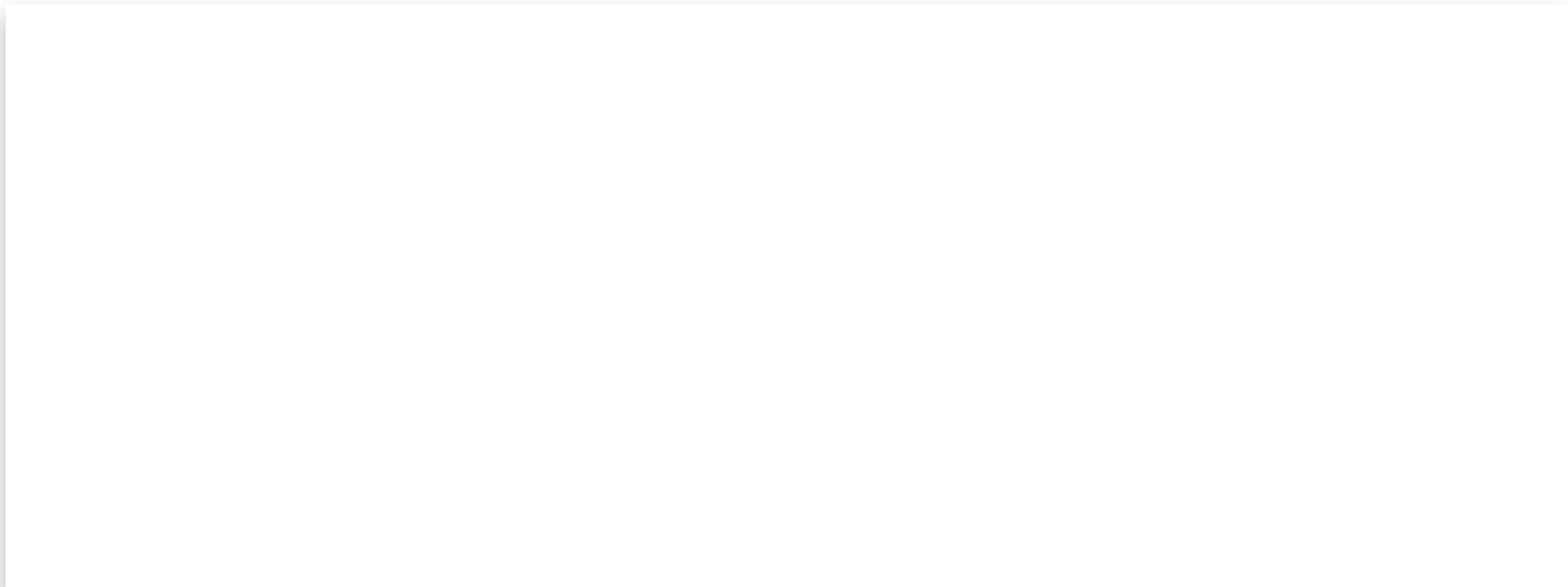
Isn't it plausible that this professor is unjustly precisely because

have decided to treat very similar students very differently?

of treating people who are irrelevant respects very similar in

This might seem at first like a tough way to go. Here's an example

different ways:



which he is forced to choose, and decides to simply his

final average of 89.50 or greater will receive an A, and



The professor

tired of the diversity of final grades for students from

The instructor of an introductory philosophy class has

every student with a final average lower than that will

grading scheme. He decides that every student with a

recovered. $\square$

from the Bible might be used to cast doubt on Propriety.

Despite this, as I point out later in the article, a parallel

quite plausible. Let's work through his reasoning.

which, from the point of standard views about judgment and the afterlife, seem

In the reading for today, Sider's aim is to present a paradox involving a series of claims



1. **Non-universality:** some people go to heaven, and some to hell.

6 **Proportionality**: justice prohibits every unequal treatment of persons

3 God send some people (group A) to heaven and some people (group B)

2 **Divine control:** it is up to God who gives to heaven and who goes to hell.

4. **Badness:** people in hell are very, very much worse off than people in

derivatives.

~Justice: God's judgement about who goes to heaven & hell is just.

9 **Dichotomy:** there are exactly two states in the afterlife, heaven and hell.

5. God makes group A much better off than group B. (3,4)

member one is very similar in relevant respects to any member the

otthier. (8,9)

to be ill. (I, as)

There is one way of dividing all humans into two groups that

8 Mon group A is very similar in relevant respects to any other group

B. (B, O, R)



which are very similar in relevant respects.

people who avoid putting relevantly similar people into different groups.

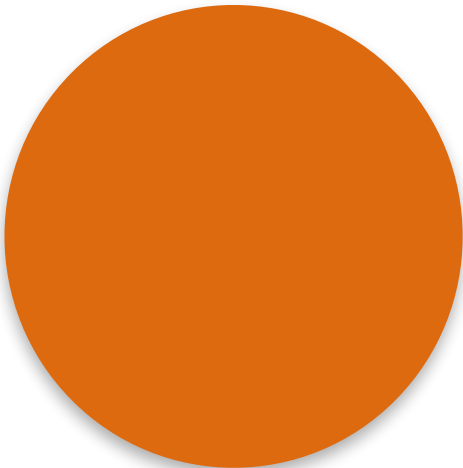
The problem, Sider thinks, is that there is no way of dividing up the population of

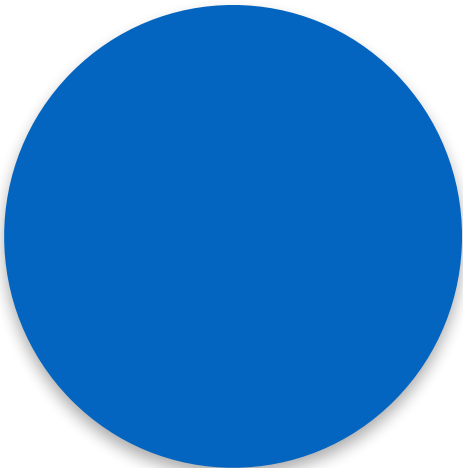
properties that God looks at to determine who goes to heaven and who to hell?

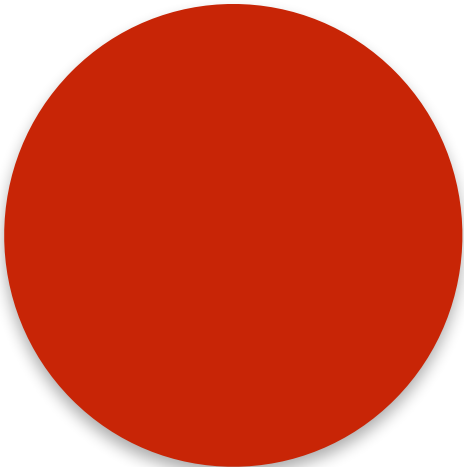
The most straightforward way to reply to the argument is to say that the conclusion of

the argument is true. Then the question is: what are the relevant respects? What are the

What could these properties be? Let's consider some possibilities.







Let's consider a different possibility. What if, when God creates a border in

hell, and instead gives the person more time to determine whether they deserve to go

to heaven or hell.

the relevant properties (whatever they are) God does not send the person to heaven or

neither heaven nor hell but rather to purgatory.

In the Catholic tradition, this is close to the idea that some people after death go to

hence, and the problem is unsolved.

deciding whether eventually goes to hell — which means

that again we need some way of dividing the 'borderline cases' from those wh

But then in deciding who goes to heaven, who to hell, and who to purgatory, God is

On the standard Catholic view, anyone who goes to purgatory eventually goes to heaven.

hello, help?

Could a different view of purgatory, one which some people in purgatory eventually go to

“The kingdom of heaven is like a landowner who went out early in the morning to hire men to work in his vineyard. He agreed to pay them a denarius for the day. About the third hour he went out and found some people in the marketplace doing nothing. He told them, “You also go and work in my vineyard and I will pay you what is right.” So they went. He went out again in the sixth hour and the ninth hour and did the same thing.

About the eleventh hour he went out and found still others standing around doing nothing. He asked them, “Why have you been standing around all day doing nothing?” “No one has hired us,” they replied. He said to them, “You also go and work in my vineyard.”

When evening came, the owner of the vineyard asked his foreman to call in the workers and pay them their wages, starting with the ones who were hired last. The workers who were hired about the eleventh hour each received a denarius. So those who were hired first expected to receive more. But each one of them also received a denarius.

When they received it, they began to grumble against the landowner, “These men who were hired last have worked only one hour, and you have made them equal to us who have worked in the heat all day.”

The landowner said, “Friend, I am not being unfair to you. Didn’t you agree to work for a denarius? Take your pay and go. I want to pay the people who were hired last the same as I paid you. Don’t I have the right to do what I want with my own money? Or are you envious because I am generous?”



the
paradox of
heaven and
hell



replies to the
paradox



evil & lives
not worth
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Let's try to layout Sider's reasoning by isolating the various features of the

traditional doctrine of heaven and hell that he thinks are inconsistent with

the existence of a perfectly good God.

“A certain traditional conception of the afterlife is *binary*. After death one proceeds either to heaven or hell. Heaven is very, very good; hell is very, very bad. There are no possibilities for the afterlife other than heaven and hell, and membership in heaven or hell is never indeterminate or a matter of degree. The problem with the binary conception is that it contradicts God's justice. God must employ some criterion to decide who goes to heaven and who goes to hell. No reasonable criterion would be sharp; any reasonable criterion will have borderline cases. But the binary conception of the afterlife allows for no corresponding fuzziness in how the dead are to be treated. Hell must therefore contain people who are nearly indiscernible in relevant respects from people in Heaven. No just God would allow such a monstrously unfair thing.”

Let's call them the relevant properties.

open for what those properties might be; just have a name for them,

It is part of the traditional doctrine that God decides whether people go to

heaven and hell based on certain properties of these people. We will have







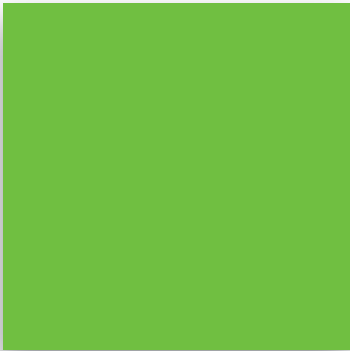
Proportion- ality



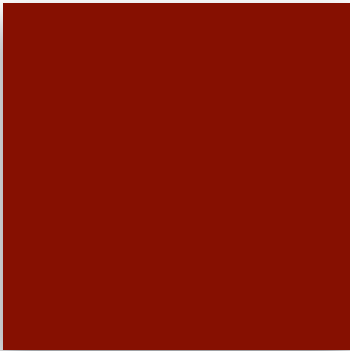
It seems difficult to deny Justice, Badness, or Divine Control. So that

seems to give the defender of the afterlife further main options.

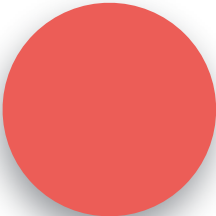




Proportion- ality



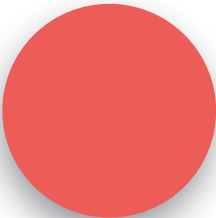






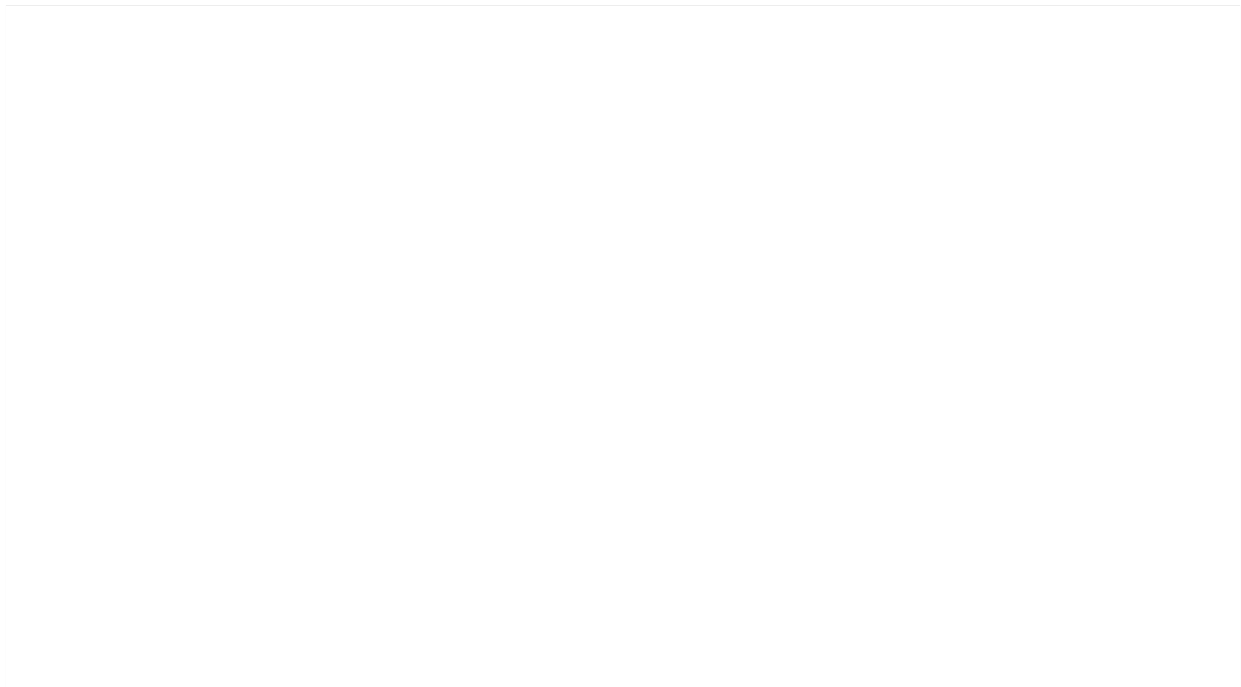
the
paradox of
heaven and
hell





describes the kind of view wanted to discuss:

The following passage from the Catechism of the Catholic Church



another as a shepherd separates the sheep from the

the angels with him... Before him will be gathered

goats, and he will place the sheep at his right hand,

eternity in life!

into external punishment, but the rights into

Judgment. Christ will come "in his glory, and all

1038. The resurrection of all the dead, 'of both the

but the goats at the left.... and they will go away

just and the unjust,' will precede the Last

all the nations, and he will separate them one from

One topic often associated with belief in God is the topic of life after death.

perfectly good Good?

many of the major monotheistic religions compatible with the existence of a

Our first question today is: what we are told about life after death by



his glory, and all the angels with him.

1038. The reservation of the dead, "of

both the just and the unjust," will proceed

the Last Judgment. . . Christ will come "in

Before him will be gathered all the nations,

and the wild sheep are then from another

as a shepherd separates the sheep from the

goats, and the wild prairie sheep at his

right hand, but the goat at the left... and

they will go away into eternal punishment,

but the rights are all in it.

got to heaven forever, and some others to hell forever. (If not 'forever', then the

This certainly seems like a picture according to which, after death, God passes

judgement on all of us, and on the basis of our life, decides that some of us will

talk of the last judgment wouldn't make much sense.)

Turned-in showed why it is plausible that respo to the argument from evil

must depend on the possibility of life after death. We will now ask: is the kind of

view of life after death we get here on pain of being perfectly good?







evil & lives
not worth
living